MARCELLO DI BELLO

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EDUCATION

Stanford University, Ph.D., Philosophy — *2007–2013*
DISSERTATION: *Statistics and Probability in Criminal Trials*

University of Amsterdam, M.Sc., Logic — *2005–2007*
M.SC. THESIS: *Formalizing Legislation in the Event Calculus*

Catholic University of Milan, B.A., Philosophy — *2001–2004*

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Arizona State University
ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR, *School of Historical, Philosophical & Religious Studies* — *from 2024*
ASSISTANT PROFESSOR, *School of Historical, Philosophical & Religious Studies* — *2020-2024*

Lehman College, City University of New York — *2014-2020*
ASSISTANT PROFESSOR, *Department of Philosophy*

Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton — *2016–2017*
INFOSYS FELLOW, *School of Social Science*

Stanford University — *2014*
LECTURER, *Department of Philosophy*

AOS

Legal Epistemology; Philosophy of Law

AOC

Philosophy of AI; Epistemology; Logic

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Evidence and probability in the law; risk and decision-making; algorithmic fairness; AI alignment

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GRANTS/ AWARDS

Fellowship, Institute for Humanities Research, ASU — *2023–2024*

Seed Grant, Institute for Humanities Research, ASU — *2022–2023*

PSC-CUNY Research Grant — *2020–2021*

Faculty Fellowship Publication Program, CUNY — *2019–2020*

Summer Seminar in the Philosophy of Statistics, Virginia Tech — *2019*

PSC-CUNY Research Grant — *2016–2017*

Fellowship, Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton — *2016–2017*

Scholar Incentive, Lehman College, CUNY — *2016–2017*

PSC-CUNY Research Grant — *2015–2016*

Huygens Scholarship, Netherlands Organization for International Cooperation — *2006-2007*

BOOKS

"**Probability on Trial: Making Sense of Arguments and Stories**" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) — *under contract*
Oxford University Press

EDITED VOLUMES

"**Evidence and Decision Making in the Law**" *2020*
Guest editor with Bart Verheij
Artificial Intelligence and Law, 28, special issue

JOURNAL ARTICLES and BOOK CHAPTERS

"**Should We Let AI Think for Us?**" (w/ Joseph Vukov) *forthcoming*
In Ballantyne, Celniker, and Schwarz (editors)
Humble Inquiry: New Perspectives on Intellectual Humility, Cambridge University Press

"**Events and Identity in Probabilistic Models of Legal Evidence**" *2026*
Quaestio Facti. Revista Internacional Sobre Razonamiento Probatorio, 11

"**Informational Richness and Its Impact on Algorithmic Fairness**" (w/ Ruobin Gong) *2025*
Philosophical Studies, 182: 25–53

"**A Probabilistic Analysis of Cross-examination Using Bayesian Networks**" *2021*
Philosophical Issues (a supplement to Noûs), 31(1): 41-65

"**When Statistical Evidence Is Not Specific Enough**" *2021*
Synthese, 199: 12251-12269

"**Legal Probabilism**" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *2021*
Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy

"**Profile Evidence, Fairness and the Risks of Mistaken Convictions**" (w/ Collin O'Neil) *2020*
Ethics, 130(2): 147-178

"**Proof Paradoxes and Normic Support: Socializing or Relativizing?**" *2020*
Mind, 129(516): 1269-1285

"**Plausibility and Reasonable Doubt in the Simonshaven Case**" *2020*
Topics in Cognitive Science, 12(4): 1200-1204

"**Trial by Statistics: Is a High Probability of Guilt Enough to Convict?**" *2019*
Mind, 128(512): 1045-1084

"**Plausibility and Probability in Juridical Proof**" *2019*
International Journal of Evidence and Proof, 23(1/2): 161-167

"**Evidential Reasoning**" (w/ Bart Verheij) *2018*
In Bongiovanni, Postema, Rotolo, Sartor, Valentini and Walton (editors)
Handbook of Legal Reasoning and Argumentation, Springer

"**Can Probability Theory Explain Why Closure Is Both Intuitive and Prone to Counterexamples?**" *2018*
Philosophical Studies, 175(9): 2145-2168

"**Epistemic Closure, Assumptions and Topics of Inquiry**" *2014*
Synthese, 191(16): 3977-4002

"**Betraying Davidson: The Quest for the Incommensurable**" *2009*
In Carrara and Morato (eds)
Language, Knowledge and Metaphysics, College Publications

"**The LKIF Core Ontology of Basic Legal Concepts**" (w/ Hoestra, Breuker and Boer) *2007*
In Casanovas, Biasiotti, Francesconi and Sagri (eds)
Proceedings of the Workshop on Legal Ontologies and Artificial Intelligence Techniques

REVIEWS

"**Douglas Walton: *Argument Evaluation and Evidence***" (w/ Bart Verheij) *2018*
Argumentation, 32(2)

TRANSLATIONS

"**L'individualizzazione come decisione**" *2020*
Philosophical Readings, 12(2) – Italian translation of Alex Biederdam, Franco Taroni and Silvia Bozza "The Decisionalization of Individualization," *Forensic Science International*, 266

TALKS
(=peer-reviewed)*

*"Evidence Without Injustice: A New Counterfactual Test for Fair Algorithms" (w/ Loi and Cangiotti) *Sept 2026*
European Workshop on Algorithmic Fairness, Ghent, Belgium

"Classifying the Causes of Wrongful Convictions" (w/ Giulia Lasagni) *Oct 2025*
North Sea Group (Groningen/King's College/Lund), online

"Can you Model an Entire Legal Case With Probabilities?" (w/ Bart Verjheij) *June 2025*
University of Girona, Michele Taruffo Evidence Week

"Sure You Are Unsure? A Defense of Higher Order Probabilism" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *Oct 2024*
University of Minnesota, Philosophy Colloquium

"Equal Protection as Algorithmic Fairness" (w/ Loi and Cangiotti) *Oct 2024*
Macalester College, Philosophy Colloquium

*"Higher-Order Legal Probabilism" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *June 2023*
International Conference on Forensic Inference and Statistics, Lund University

"Gaps in the Evidence" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *June 2023*
University of Groningen

*"Causal Equal Protection and Algorithmic Fairness" (w/ Loi and Cangiotti) *June 2023*
European Workshop on Algorithmic Fairness, Winterthur, Switzerland

"Gaps in the Evidence" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *May 2023*
Epistemology Workshop on Legal Epistemology, Orange Beach, Alabama

"Gaps in the Evidence" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *Mar. 2023*
Legal Philosophy Trident seminar (Leeds, Pompeu Fabra, Torcuato di Tella), online

*"Causal Equal Protection and Algorithmic Fairness" (w/ Loi and Cangiotti) *Jan. 2023*
Philosophy and AI Society (PAIS) Workshop, Stanford University

"Accuracy and the Weight of Evidence" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *Nov. 2022*
North Sea Group (Groningen/King's College/Lund), online

"Artificial Intelligence for Judges" (w/ Giulia Lasagni) *Nov. 2022*
Faculty of Law, University of Lisbon

*"Cross-Examination with Bayesian Networks" *Oct. 2022*
BayesiaLab Conference, online

"Unanticipated Possibilities for Legal Probabilism" *May 2022*
Michele Taruffo Evidence Week, University of Girona

"The Conjunction Paradox" (w/ Rafal Urbaniak) *Mar. 2022*
Information Ethics Workshop, Northeastern University

*"Is Algorithmic Fairness Possible?" *Nov. 2021*
Biennial Meeting of the Philosophy of Science Association, Baltimore

"Resolving Algorithmic Fairness" (w/ Ruobin Gong) *Nov. 2020*
Australian National University, online

TALKS
(cont'd)
(=peer-reviewed)*

*"Is Algorithmic Fairness Possible?" – postponed *Nov. 2020*
Biennial Meeting of the Philosophy of Science Association, Baltimore

"Probability and Conviction" – cancelled *Aug. 2020*
Netherland Institute for Advanced Study

"Statistical *versus* Specific Evidence" *Mar. 2020*
University of California, San Diego, Halicioglu Data Science Institute

*"Varieties of Statistical Evidence" – cancelled *Mar. 2020*
Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Society, New Orleans

"Profile Evidence, Fairness and the Risks of Mistaken Convictions" *Jan. 2020*
University of Alabama, Department of Philosophy

"Is Algorithmic Fairness Possible?" *Nov. 2019*
Rutgers University

"Comments on Dahlman's 'Statistical Evidence and the Futility of Lawful Conduct'" *Nov. 2019*
University of Groningen

"Statistics in the Courtroom: What Is Wrong With Them?" *Feb. 2019*
University of Nevada, Las Vegas

"Statistics in the Courtroom: Do They Threaten the Fair Trial?" *Jan. 2018*
Polytechnic University of Milan

"Rethinking the Prosecutor's Fallacy" *Nov. 2017*
CUNY Graduate Center, Philosophy Colloquium

*"Does More Evidence Lead to Fewer Errors?" *Oct. 2017*
High Performance Computing Center, University of Stuttgart

*"A Two-dimensional Theory of Proof Beyond a Reasonable Doubt" *June 2017*
Truth and the Criminal Trial, University of Nottingham

"Statistics in the Courtroom: Do They Threaten the Fair Trial?" *April 2017*
Institute for Advanced Study, Princeton

"Statistics in the Courtroom: Do They Threaten the Fair Trial?" *Jan. 2017*
University of Lausanne

*"Can Probability Explain the Successes and Failures of Epistemic Closure?" *Sept. 2016*
XII SIFA Conference, University of Siena

*"Fairness and Statistical Evidence" *Sept. 2016*
XII SIFA Conference, University of Siena

*"Is a High Probability of Guilt Enough to Convict?" *Jan. 2016*
Legal Theory Research Group, University of Edinburgh

"Is a High Probability of Guilt Enough to Convict?" *June 2015*
International AI & Law Conference, University of San Diego

"Is a High Probability of Guilt Enough to Convict?" *May 2015*
University of Bayreuth

"Beyond a Reasonable Doubt: Probability and Certainty in Criminal Trials" *May 2015*
Catholic University of Milan

TALKS (cont'd) (*=peer-reviewed)

"Statistics, Eyewitnesses, and Fingerprints" *May 2012*
International Conference on Law, Governance and Development, Bangalore

"The Wells Effect, Lotteries, and Newspapers" *Aug. 2011*
National Institute of Advanced Studies, Bangalore

"DNA evidence: the Illusionary Precision of Numbers" *Aug. 2011*
Alternative Law Forum, Bangalore

"Individualized Evidence" *June 2010*
Istituto Bruno Leoni, Milan

*"Betraying Davidson: a Quest for the Incommensurable" *Sept. 2007*
First SIFA Graduate Conference, University of Padua

TEACHING (*=T.A.)

ASU	Legal probabilism	*Fall 2024*
	Race, Causality and Discrimination	*Fall 2023*
	The Common Ground	*Spring 2023*
	Algorithmic Fairness	*Fall 2021*
	Bayesian Networks in Philosophy	*Spring 2021*
	Philosophy of Law	*Fall 2020, 2021, 2023, 2025; Spring 2021, 2022, 2026*
	Ethics, Big Data and AI	*Fall 2020; Spring 2025*
CUNY, LEHMAN	Asian Philosophies	*Spring 2019*
	Introduction to Logic	*Spring 2019, 2020*
	Is the Criminal Justice System Racist?	*Spring 2018*
	Philosophy of Law	*Spring 2015, 2016, 2020*
	Legal Reasoning	*Fall 2015, 2017, 2019*
	Critical Reasoning	*Fall 2014, 2017, 2018; Spring 2015, 2016, 2018*
	Problems of Philosophy	*Fall 2014, 2015, 2017, 2019*
BAYREUTH	Math on Trial	*Summer 2015*
	Convicting the Innocent	*Summer 2016*
STANFORD	Introduction to Logic	*Spring 2014*
	Probability and the Law	*Winter 2013, 2014*
	Political Philosophy*	*Spring 2010*
	Ancient Greek Philosophy*	*Winter 2012*
	First-order Logic (up to completeness)*	*Winter 2009, Spring 2011*
QINGDAO	Introduction to Statistics	*Summer 2013*
	Introduction to Philosophy	*Summer 2013*

REFEREEING

Canadian Journal of Philosophy; *Pacific Philosophical Quarterly*; *Economics and Philosophy*; *Noûs*; *Journal of Ethics & Social Philosophy*; *Philosophical Review*; *Episteme*; *Ethics*; *Philosopher's Imprint*; *Mind*; *Australasian Journal of Philosophy*; *Journal of Moral Philosophy*; *Analysis*; *Philosophy Compass*; *International Journal of Evidence & Proof*; *Philosophical Studies*; *Law, Probability, and Risk*; *Philosophical Quarterly*; *Philosophy of Science*; *Applied Ontology*; *Erkenntnis*; *Synthese*; *Artificial Intelligence and Law*; *Frontiers in Sociology*

ORGANIZATION CONFERENCES/ SYMPOSIA

"Social Studies of Data" (w/ Ben Gansky) *Oct. 2022*
Arizona State University

"Is Racial Equity Possible?" *Mar. 2019*
Lehman College, CUNY

ORGANIZATION CONFERENCES/ SYMPOSIA *(cont'd)*

"Fighting Fake News with Math and Logic" *May 2018*
Lehman College, CUNY

"Evidence and Decision Making in the Law" (w/ Bart Verheij) *June 2017*
King's College London

"Studying Evidence in the Law" (w/ Bart Verheij) *June 2015*
University of San Diego

"The Killing of Michael Brown and Eric Gardner" *May 2015*
Lehman College, CUNY

"Trial With and Without Mathematics" (w/ Bart Verheij) *May 2014*
Stanford Law School

SUPERVISION

Yashin Voss, "Nihilism, Anarchism and Social Categories" *ongoing*
Ph.D. Thesis in Philosophy (committee member)
Arizona State University

Aubrey Spivey, "Gender and Disability within the Prison" *ongoing*
Ph.D. Thesis in Philosophy (committee member)
Arizona State University

Gus Raycraft, "AI on the Couch: A Lacanian Encounter with the Black Box" *2025*
Barrett Honors B.A. Thesis in Philosophy (main advisor)
Arizona State University

Samuel Thomas, "De Re Beliefs and Evidence in Legal Cases" *2021*
M.A. Thesis in Philosophy (main advisor)
Arizona State University

Charles Barclay, "A New Theory of Individualized Evidence" *2021*
Ph.D. Thesis in Philosophy (committee member)
University of Maryland

Tera Phelps, "Horror and Slasher Films: A New Perspective" *2020*
B.A. Thesis in Philosophy
Lehman College

Tasmina Khair, "Philosophical Considerations of Juvenile Incarceration Trajectories from Adverse Childhood Experiences" *2019*
B.A. Thesis in Philosophy
Lehman College

Lillian Rosado Barreto, "The Perpetuation of Mass Incarceration" *2018*
B.A. Thesis in Political Science and Philosophy
Lehman College

Lino Hower, "Consequentialism and Rights" *2016*
B. A. Thesis in Philosophy and Economics
University of Bayreuth